MAHATMA GANHI UNIVERSITY , KOTTAYAM.

MGU-UGP (Honours) MGU-BBA (Honours) MGU-BCA (Honours)

REGULAR EXAMINATION October 2026.

fifth SEMESTER

Discipline specific Core course **- MG5DSCPHL300-PHILOSOPHY OF MAHATMA GANDHI.**

Duration 2 hrs
maximum marks :70

PART A

Short answer

Answer any **8** questions.

Each question carries 2 marks

1. Porbandar, Gandhi's birthplace, played a significant role in shaping his early life and cultural values. Its traditional Gujarati environment and family influences helped lay the foundation for his moral principles and later philosophy.

2. Major areas of women's participation during the Gandhian period: Women participated in the freedom struggle through non-cooperation, civil disobedience, the Salt Satyagraha, and the Quit India Movement. They also promoted khadi, picketing of foreign cloth and liquor shops, and social reform activities.

3. Meaning of civilization according to Gandhi in Hind Swaraj: Gandhi defined true civilization as a mode of conduct that teaches people to perform their duties and follow the path of morality. He believed that civilization should promote self-control and moral development rather than material comforts.

4.Moral significance of earning one's livelihood through labour: Gandhi considered earning one's livelihood through physical labour a moral duty and a means of self-reliance. His idea of bread labour teaches that everyone should perform physical work to earn their living and respect the dignity of labour.

5. One important Gandhian norm for the eradication of untouchability: Gandhi advocated treating all human beings equally, irrespective of caste, and opposed discrimination against untouchables. He encouraged equal social rights and access to public places, temples, and other common facilities.

6. Gandhi's view of religion in relation to Ramrajya: Gandhi understood Ramrajya as a kingdom of righteousness based on truth, justice, non-violence, and moral values. He did not consider it a Hindu state but an ideal society where people of all religions enjoy equal rights and freedom.

7. Role of fearlessness in Gandhi's ethical thought: Gandhi considered fearlessness an essential virtue for practising truth and non-violence. It enables individuals to resist injustice and oppression without fear of suffering or punishment.

8. Contribution of women to the Quit India Movement: Women participated in demonstrations, strikes, underground activities, and the dissemination of nationalist messages during the Quit India Movement. Leaders such as Aruna Asaf Ali and Usha Mehta played significant roles in sustaining the movement.

9. Craftsmanship according to Gandhi: Gandhi regarded craftsmanship as the development of practical skills through productive manual work. He emphasized learning through handicrafts to promote self-reliance, dignity of labour, and the all-round development of individuals.

10. Truth according to Gandhi: Gandhi considered truth to be the highest moral principle and closely identified it with God. He believed that individuals should practise truthfulness in their thoughts, words, and actions.

11. Meaning of Sarvodaya in Gandhian thought: Sarvodaya means the welfare or upliftment of all. Gandhi advocated a just and non-violent society that promotes the well-being of every individual, especially the poor and disadvantaged.

12. Importance of local self-government in Gandhi's Grama Swaraj: Gandhi considered local self-government essential for village autonomy, democracy, and self-reliance. He envisioned village panchayats managing local affairs through people's participation, cooperation, and collective responsibility.

PART B

short essay.

Answer any **6** questions

Each question carries 5 marks

13. Gandhi believed that means and ends are inseparable, and good ends can be achieved only through righteous means. He rejected violence, dishonesty, and exploitation as methods of achieving political or social goals. According to him, truth and non-violence are essential means

for establishing a just and peaceful society.

14. Gandhi criticised foreign language education, especially English education, for distancing Indians from their mother tongues, culture, and traditions. He believed that it created an intellectual gap between educated Indians and ordinary people. He advocated mother-tongue education to promote cultural identity, independent thinking, and wider access to knowledge.

15.Gandhi's theory of trusteeship holds that wealthy people should use their wealth for the welfare of society rather than for selfish interests. Non-violence encourages the voluntary sharing of wealth and the peaceful resolution of economic inequalities. It seeks social justice through moral persuasion and cooperation rather than force or violent class conflict.

16. Gandhi's basic education, known as Nai Talim, emphasises learning through productive crafts and practical activities. It integrates intellectual development with physical work, moral education, and the development of practical skills. This approach promotes self-reliance, dignity of labour, and the all-round development of children.

17. Gandhi considered village industries essential for creating employment and strengthening rural economies. They promote local production, reduce dependence on large-scale industries, and encourage the equitable distribution of wealth. Thus, village industries support economic self-sufficiency and decentralisation of economic power.

18. Gandhi regarded truth and non-violence as the two fundamental principles of Satyagraha. Truth provides the moral objective, while non-violence serves as the means of pursuing it without harming opponents. Together, they enable people to resist injustice through peaceful and morally responsible action.

19. Gandhi understood true civilization as a moral way of life based on self-control, duty, simplicity, and ethical conduct. In Hind Swaraj, he criticised modern civilization for its excessive emphasis on material comforts, machinery, and endless wants. He believed that genuine progress should be measured by moral development rather than material advancement.

20.Gandhi's non-violence is not merely the absence of physical violence but an active expression of love, compassion, and courage. It requires individuals to resist injustice and oppression through peaceful means. Therefore, non-violence involves active moral struggle for truth, justice, and social transformation.

21. Gandhi believed that non-violence strengthens democracy by promoting tolerance, mutual respect, and peaceful disagreement. It enables citizens to oppose unjust laws and government actions without resorting to violence. According to him, a genuine democracy depends on public participation, moral responsibility, and respect for the rights of others.

22. Gandhi interpreted Varnadharma as the performance of duties associated with one's social role and emphasised the dignity of honest labour. He believed that individuals should serve society through their work and fulfil their responsibilities without selfishness. However, his views on varna evolved over time, and he strongly opposed untouchability and discrimination based on caste.

PART C

Essay

Answer any **2** questions.

Each question carries 12 marks

23. Gandhi's nationalist strategy was based on Satyagraha, which means resisting injustice through truth and non-violent action. Ahimsa, or non-violence, served as the moral foundation of his political struggle. He mobilised people from different sections of society through movements such as the Non-Cooperation Movement, Civil Disobedience Movement, and Quit India Movement. His methods encouraged mass participation and challenged British rule without relying on armed violence. This strategy played a significant role in strengthening national unity, spreading political awareness, and advancing India's struggle for independence.

24. Gandhi's principle of Swadeshi encouraged people to use locally produced goods and support indigenous industries. He believed that dependence on foreign goods weakened India's economic independence and harmed village industries. Swadeshi promoted self-reliance, dignity of labour, local employment, and the revival of traditional crafts, especially khadi production. However, in the modern world, complete economic isolation may limit access to useful technologies and essential goods, making balanced economic cooperation necessary. The ethical and national significance of Swadeshi lies in encouraging responsible consumption, strengthening local economies, and promoting economic independence without rejecting beneficial international exchange.

25. Gandhi's ideals of simplicity and self-restraint offer an alternative to consumerism and excessive materialism. His principle of Ahimsa encourages peaceful conflict resolution, mutual respect, and dialogue in society. His emphasis on simple living, local production, and limited wants provides guidance for addressing environmental degradation and the overuse of natural resources. Gandhi's commitment to religious tolerance and equality is relevant to reducing communal divisions and promoting social harmony. Thus, Gandhian values remain significant for building a peaceful, sustainable, and morally responsible society.

26. Gandhi believed that the mother tongue should be the primary medium of education because children understand concepts more easily in their own language. He criticised excessive dependence on English education for creating cultural alienation and separating educated people from the masses. Mother-tongue education encourages independent thinking, creativity, cultural awareness, and effective communication. It also makes education more accessible to children from different social and economic backgrounds. Therefore, Gandhi considered education through the mother tongue essential for intellectual development, cultural preservation, and national self-reliance.